

Monthly executive summary covering global market conditions, sector themes, macro backdrop, and key risks as of the report date. All figures are simulated.

Executive Summary

Global financial markets closed February 2026 in a range-bound posture, characterised by indecisive price action across asset classes. The S&P 500 fell 7.9% year-to-date, with large-cap technology continuing to lead on the back of AI-related earnings momentum. The NASDAQ 100 advanced 6.9% YTD, while broader indices reflected more mixed returns as rate-sensitive sectors lagged. Cross-asset, equities averaged +0.8% YTD, fixed income +1.9%, and commodities +1.4%.

Equity Markets

The best-performing benchmark in the period was MSCI World (+11.2% YTD), driven by strong earnings revisions and favourable sector composition. At the sector level, Info. Technology (+14.8% YTD) led the market, while Communication Svcs (-7.8% YTD) lagged amid headwinds from earnings misses and softening demand. Emerging markets remained under pressure (MSCI EM -11.4% YTD), with dollar strength and geopolitical uncertainty weighing on sentiment.

Fixed Income & Rates

The Federal Reserve held policy at current levels, keeping the Fed Funds target range unchanged while reiterating data-dependency. Long-duration Treasuries rallied (1.1% YTD), as markets debated the trajectory of terminal rates. Credit spreads remained broadly contained, with high-yield +1.6% YTD. The investment-grade corporate market held up relatively well, underpinned by solid balance sheets and limited near-term refinancing risk. The Fed is currently restrictive — with further tightening not ruled out.

Commodities

Gold moved modestly higher (+0.0% YTD), supported by central bank demand and geopolitical hedging. WTI crude oil gained 1.0% YTD, reflecting supply discipline from OPEC+ and firm demand. Industrial metals were mixed: copper benefited from China stimulus hopes, while natural gas remained volatile given storage dynamics and weather effects.

Macro Backdrop

The US economy continued its resilient expansion heading into February 2026. Headline CPI stood at 5.3% YoY, with Core PCE at 7.4% — still above the Fed's 2% target. The labour market remained tight, with unemployment at 3.0% and nonfarm payrolls printing +679K in the latest month. Consumer spending has been supported by real wage growth, though some moderation is expected as excess savings are depleted. Global growth diverged: the Eurozone showed tentative stabilisation while China's recovery remained uneven.

MARKET REGIME

Range-bound

Rates: Restrictive

KEY STATS — FEB 2026	
S&P 500 YTD	-7.9%
NASDAQ 100 YTD	+6.9%
Top Sector	Info. Technology
CPI (Headline)	5.3% YoY
Unemployment	3.0%
NFP (Latest)	+679K

KEY THEMES
• AI capital expenditure cycle driving tech outperformance
• Disinflation progress — Fed rate-cut trajectory in focus
• US exceptionalism vs. slowing global growth divergence
• Geopolitical risk premium embedded in energy & gold
• Credit resilience underpins risk appetite

RISKS TO WATCH
⚠ Re-acceleration of inflation derailing rate-cut path
⚠ Labour market softening faster than expected
⚠ Geopolitical escalation disrupting energy supply
⚠ China property sector tail-risk re-emerging

OUTLOOK

Modestly positive risk posture. Selective equity exposure favoured; monitor inflation prints closely for Fed pivot catalysts. Overweight gold and short duration.

Performance of major global benchmarks across equities, fixed income, and commodities. Returns over 3M, 6M, YTD, and 1Y. Est. Flow = 3-month buying-pressu

EQUITY					FIXED INCOME					COMMODITIES							
	3M	6M	YTD	1Y Flow(\$B)		3M	6M	YTD	1Y Flow(\$B)		3M	6M	YTD	1Y Flow(\$B)			
S&P 500	-8.34%	6.72%	7.87%	9.36%	+18.4	US Aggregate	+2.43%	0.98%	5.04%	7.24%	+6.1	Gold	+3.71%	10.38%	0.00%	20.68%	+11.3
Dow Jones	+3.94%	2.70%	4.86%	5.98%	+12.1	20Y+ Treasury	-2.06%	7.10%	1.06%	9.65%	-4.3	WTI Crude	-0.22%	9.02%	1.05%	6.32%	-8.7
NASDAQ 100	+2.11%	13.94%	6.94%	42.12%	+24.7	7-10Y Treasury	+0.59%	4.05%	1.43%	1.34%	+2.8	Silver	-3.33%	0.36%	4.56%	34.00%	+4.2
Russell 2000	+0.29%	2.68%	1.00%	9.92%	-3.2	High Yield	+3.03%	2.99%	1.62%	11.59%	+8.9	Natural Gas	-11.28%	7.40%	1.32%	87.26%	-12.1
MSCI World	+17.77%	24.38%	1.25%	7.46%	+9.5	IG Corporate	+3.62%	5.29%	1.89%	4.86%	+3.7	Copper	+0.47%	2.89%	2.24%	17.21%	+3.6
MSCI EM	-17.65%	4.12%	1.39%	8.06%	-5.8	TIPS	+3.53%	8.19%	3.01%	18.13%	+1.2	Broad Cmdty	+4.96%	1.98%	1.95%	19.17%	-2.4

10-Year Indexed Price History



For informational purposes only. All data is simulated. Sources: Yahoo Finance, FRED, BLS.

Equity Sector Analysis

February 28, 2026

GICS sector performance (SPDR ETF proxies) ranked by YTD return. Street Views = sell-side consensus as of report date. B/H/S = # analyst Buy / Hold / Sell ratio

Sector Performance — YTD vs 3M



Sector	ETF	AUM	YTD%	3M%	1M%	Rating	B / H / S
Info. Technology	XLK	2800	+14.8%	+16.8%	+14.4%	OW	28 / 8 / 2
Health Care	XLV	750	+4.1%	+0.8%	+1.9%	N	18 / 15 / 5
Financials	XLF	680	+10.4%	+13.7%	-2.1%	OW	22 / 12 / 3
Cons. Discretionary	XLY	500	-0.0%	-2.7%	+0.0%	N	16 / 18 / 6
Communication Svcs	XLC	460	-7.8%	-1.5%	-1.1%	OW	20 / 10 / 3
Industrials	XLI	430	-1.9%	-9.6%	-1.9%	OW	19 / 13 / 4
Consumer Staples	XLP	420	-5.3%	-7.3%	-3.6%	UW	10 / 18 / 10
Energy	XLE	370	-1.4%	+6.9%	+1.1%	N	15 / 16 / 8
Utilities	XLU	140	+0.8%	-0.9%	+1.1%	N	12 / 17 / 8
Real Estate	XLRE	130	+4.4%	+7.2%	+6.9%	N	14 / 16 / 7
Materials	XLB	120	-0.4%	+9.6%	+0.2%	N	13 / 17 / 6

Info. Technology

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
AAPL	+3.20%	1.10%	+29.5	+1.2	+1.80	AAPL

Health Care

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
LLY	+7.10%	2.00%	+52.0	+1.8	+0.40	LLY

Financials

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
BRK-B	+5.20%	1.50%	+22.0	—	+0.30	BRK-B

Cons. Discretionary

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
AMZN	+9.20%	3.10%	+45.0	+3.2	+0.60	AMZN

Communication Svcs

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
GOOGL	+6.80%	2.40%	+22.0	+0.2	+0.10	GOOGL

Industrials

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
GE	+6.20%	2.10%	+28.0	+1.5	+0.60	GE

Consumer Staples

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
WMT	+4.30%	1.20%	+30.0	+1.8	+0.90	WMT

Energy

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
XOM	+1.80%	0.50%	+13.0	+0.8	+0.40	XOM

Utilities

Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	D/EBITDA	Av.(D/E)	Name
NEE	+3.20%	0.80%	+22.0	+6.5	+1.50	NEE

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	AMD	+18.50%	+5.20%	38.0	340
2	NVDA	+12.40%	+4.50%	55.0	3200
3	CRM	+9.80%	+3.20%	45.0	280
4	AVGO	+6.80%	+1.80%	28.1	780
5	MSFT	+5.10%	+2.30%	35.2	3050

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	INTC	-8.20%	-3.10%	12.0	95
2	ADBE	-2.40%	-0.80%	38.0	225
3	QCOM	+3.10%	+0.90%	18.0	175
4	AAPL	+3.20%	+1.10%	29.5	3100
5	ORCL	+4.20%	+0.90%	24.3	450

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	ISRG	+11.20%	+3.80%	60.0	185
2	LLY	+7.10%	+2.00%	52.0	780
3	TMO	+4.80%	+1.50%	32.0	210
4	ABBV	+3.50%	+1.10%	18.2	310
5	UNH	+2.30%	+0.60%	21.0	470

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	BMJ	-4.80%	-1.50%	12.0	125
2	CVS	-3.50%	-1.10%	11.0	78
3	MRK	+1.20%	-0.20%	14.8	280
4	MDT	+1.50%	+0.40%	17.0	108
5	JNJ	+1.80%	+0.30%	15.5	380

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



Constituent Performance — YTD Return

▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	GS	+10.20%	+2.80%	14.0	185
2	AXP	+9.80%	+2.50%	22.0	185
3	MS	+8.50%	+2.20%	16.0	165
4	JPM	+8.10%	+2.20%	12.8	680
5	V	+7.30%	+2.00%	32.0	520

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	BAC	+4.30%	+1.00%	11.5	330
2	BRK-B	+5.20%	+1.50%	22.0	890
3	C	+6.10%	+1.50%	10.0	108
4	MA	+6.90%	+1.80%	35.5	465
5	WFC	+7.20%	+2.00%	13.0	220

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	AMZN	+9.20%	+3.10%	45.0	2100
2	BKNG	+5.20%	+1.60%	28.0	150
3	GM	+4.20%	+1.10%	6.0	58
4	HD	+3.80%	+0.90%	22.0	360
5	LOW	+2.90%	+0.70%	22.0	148

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	TSLA	-8.50%	-3.20%	80.0	700
2	F	-6.80%	-2.30%	7.5	34
3	TGT	-5.10%	-1.80%	16.0	62
4	NKE	-4.20%	-1.50%	35.0	88
5	SBUX	-3.20%	-1.00%	28.0	92

Sector ETF — 10-Year History (5/11)

February 28, 2026

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



Constituent Performance — YTD Return

▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	META	+8.10%	+3.20%	28.0	1500
2	NFLX	+7.30%	+2.50%	42.0	340
3	GOOGL	+6.80%	+2.40%	22.0	2200
4	OMC	+3.80%	+1.10%	14.0	22
5	DIS	+2.10%	+0.40%	38.0	195

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	IPG	-4.20%	-1.30%	12.0	14
2	CHTR	-2.80%	-0.80%	52.0	52
3	TTWO	-1.50%	-0.50%	—	28
4	T	-1.50%	-0.50%	11.0	97
5	EA	+2.10%	+0.50%	32.0	38

Sector ETF — 10-Year History (6/11)

February 28, 2026

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	LMT	+8.20%	+2.50%	18.0	145
2	GE	+6.20%	+2.10%	28.0	180
3	DE	+5.80%	+1.70%	22.0	125
4	RTX	+5.10%	+1.80%	38.0	150
5	CAT	+4.50%	+1.30%	17.0	155

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	BA	-9.50%	-3.20%	—	115
2	MMM	+1.50%	+0.40%	16.0	68
3	HON	+2.80%	+0.70%	24.0	130
4	FDX	+3.20%	+0.90%	18.0	68
5	UNP	+3.20%	+0.90%	22.0	145

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = 1



Constituent Performance — YTD Return

▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	COST	+5.80%	+1.90%	52.0	385
2	PM	+5.50%	+1.80%	16.0	168
3	WMT	+4.30%	+1.20%	30.0	680
4	CL	+3.20%	+0.90%	26.0	60
5	MO	+2.80%	+0.80%	12.0	82

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	STZ	-2.50%	-0.80%	32.0	42
2	PEP	+1.20%	+0.30%	23.0	235
3	KO	+1.50%	+0.40%	24.0	270
4	MDLZ	+1.80%	+0.50%	22.0	78
5	PG	+2.10%	+0.50%	26.0	380

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



Constituent Performance — YTD Return

▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	PSX	+2.50%	+0.70%	12.0	58
2	XOM	+1.80%	-0.50%	13.0	480
3	VLO	+1.80%	+0.50%	10.0	52
4	CVX	+1.20%	-0.80%	14.0	300
5	COP	+0.80%	-1.20%	12.0	140

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	DVN	-4.80%	-1.50%	9.0	22
2	HAL	-3.50%	-1.20%	16.0	32
3	SLB	-2.10%	-1.00%	18.0	62
4	OXY	-0.80%	-0.30%	12.0	52
5	EOG	+0.50%	-0.90%	11.5	72

Sector ETF — 10-Year History (9/11)

February 28, 2026

10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	NEE	+3.20%	+0.80%	22.0	125
2	AWK	+2.50%	+0.70%	32.0	28
3	SO	+2.10%	+0.50%	18.0	80
4	DUK	+1.80%	+0.40%	17.0	72
5	WEC	+1.80%	+0.50%	22.0	28

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return

#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	ETR	+0.50%	+0.10%	14.0	22
2	EXC	+0.80%	+0.20%	16.0	48
3	PCG	+1.20%	+0.30%	20.0	52
4	D	+1.20%	+0.20%	15.0	45
5	AEP	+1.50%	+0.30%	16.0	50

Sector ETF — 10-Year History (10/11)

February 28, 2026

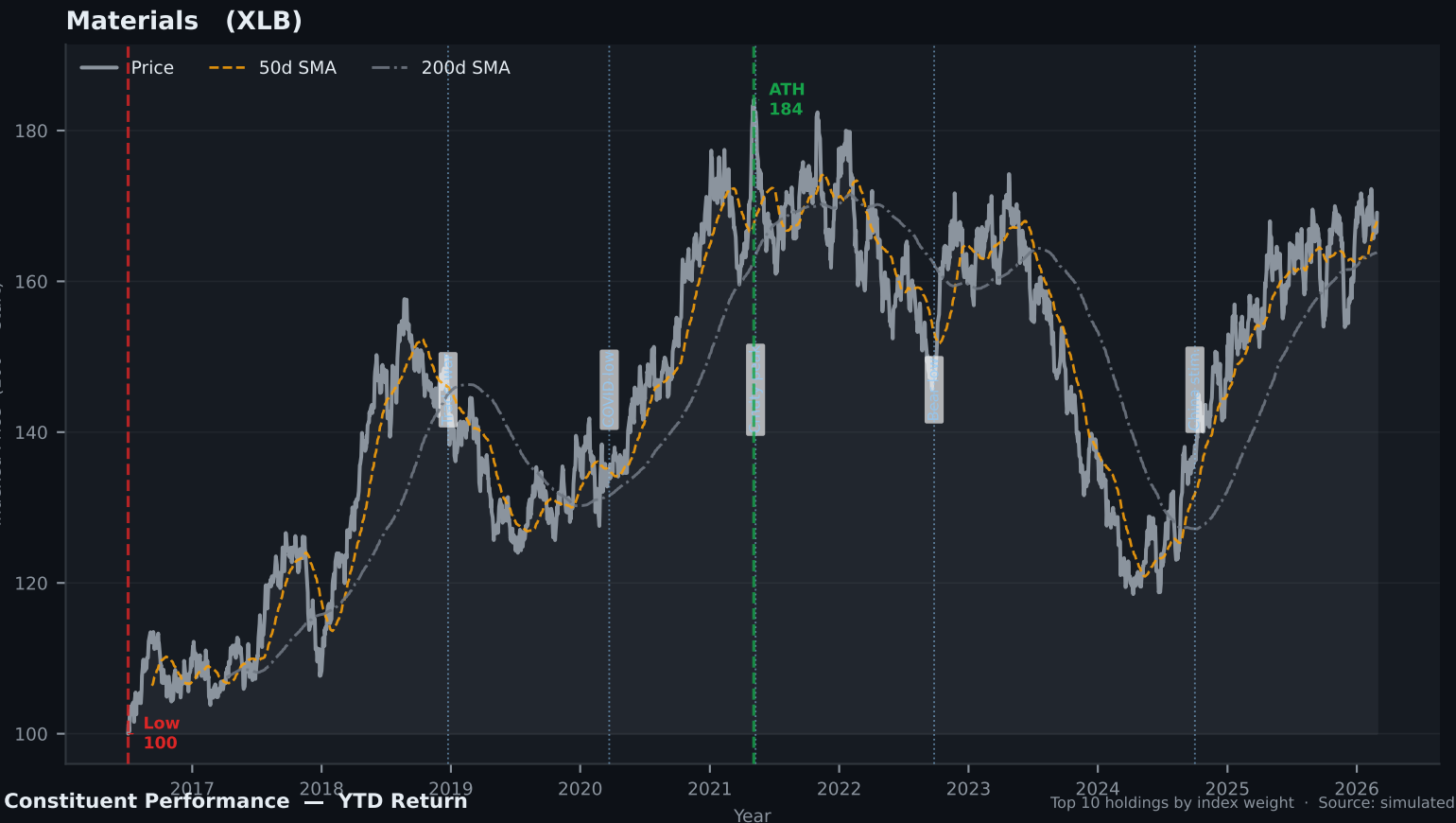
10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	SPG	+5.50%	+1.80%	32.0	68
2	PLD	+4.20%	+1.50%	42.0	115
3	EQIX	+3.50%	+1.20%	88.0	82
4	VTR	+3.20%	+0.90%	88.0	18
5	AMT	+2.80%	+0.80%	48.0	98

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	EQR	-1.50%	-0.50%	52.0	32
2	AVB	+1.20%	+0.30%	48.0	28
3	PSA	+1.50%	+0.40%	28.0	52
4	O	+1.80%	+0.50%	52.0	48
5	ARE	+2.10%	+0.60%	55.0	22

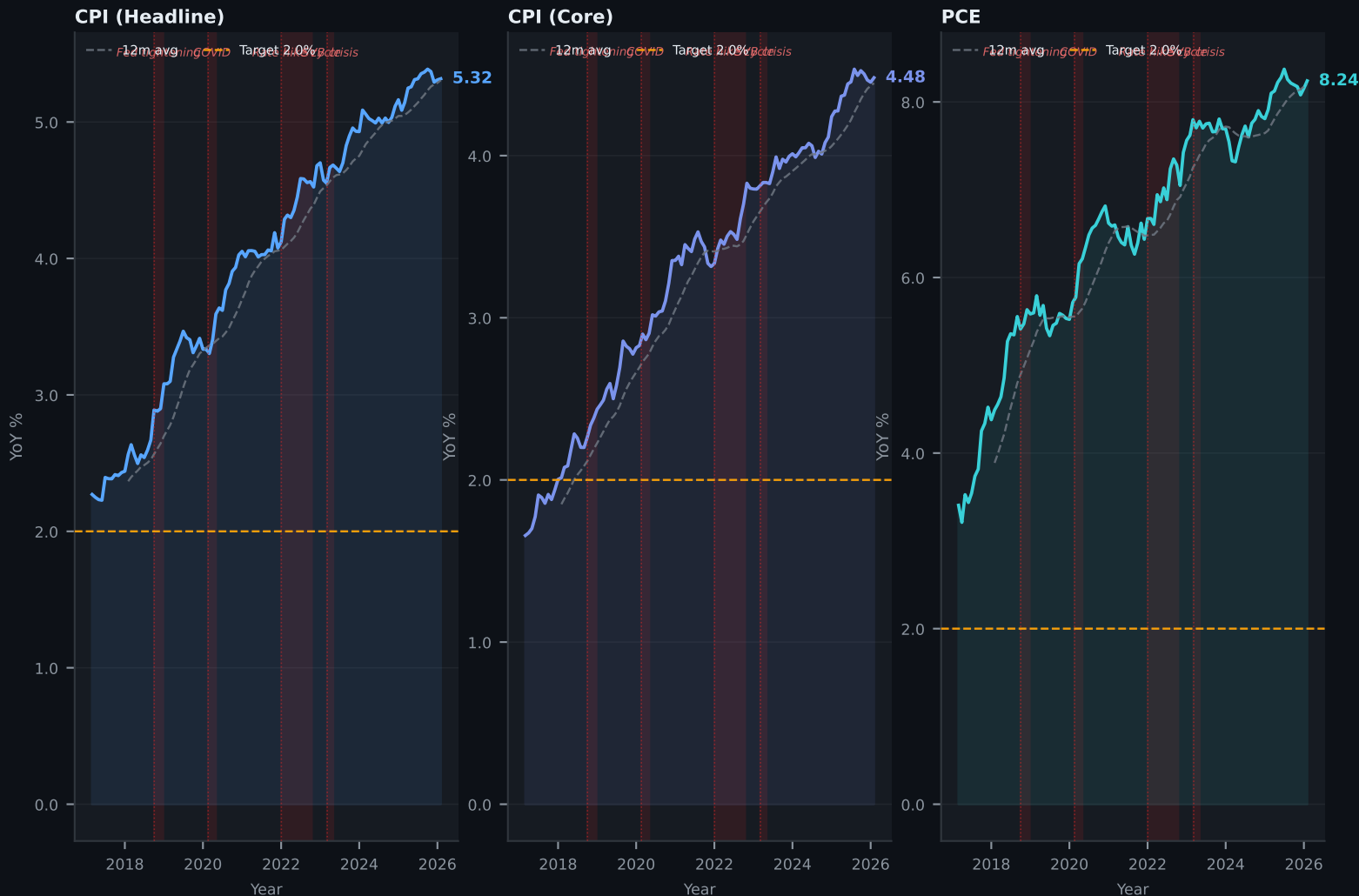
10-year indexed price history (100 = Feb 2016). Dashed = 50d SMA, dash-dot = 200d SMA. Green bar = period ATH, red bar = period low. Dotted verticals = I



▲ Top 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	NEM	+9.10%	+3.50%	18.0	42
2	FCX	+8.50%	+3.20%	15.0	55
3	VMC	+6.20%	+1.80%	28.0	28
4	LIN	+5.20%	+1.50%	32.0	220
5	SHW	+4.50%	+1.30%	32.0	88

▼ Bottom 5 Performers — YTD Return					
#	Ticker	YTD%	1M%	P/E	Mkt Cap
1	ALB	-8.20%	-2.80%	18.0	8
2	MOS	-3.50%	-1.20%	12.0	12
3	PPG	+2.80%	+0.80%	22.0	38
4	APD	+3.20%	+0.90%	28.0	65
5	NUE	+4.50%	+1.20%	10.0	42

CPI Headline, Core CPI & PCE — year-over-year % change, 10-year history. Dashed amber = Fed 2% target. Shaded pink = macro stress periods. Dashed grey =

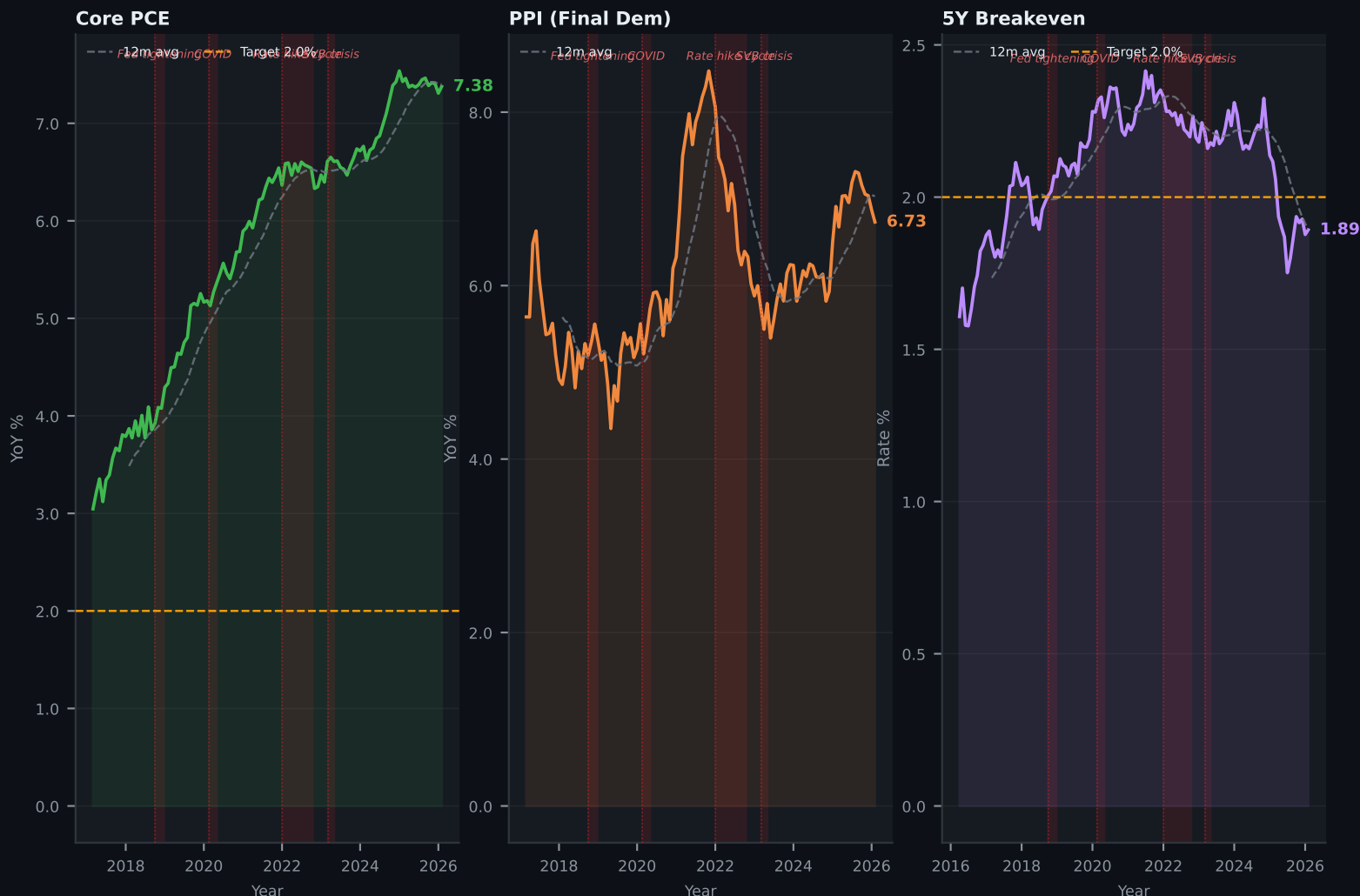


MACRO ANALYSIS — INFLATION

- CPI (Headline): 5.3% YoY — Stable from 5.4% six months ago; currently 3.3pp above the 2% target.
- CPI (Core): 4.5% YoY — Stable from 4.5% six months ago; currently 2.5pp above the 2% target.
- PCE: 8.2% YoY — Stable from 8.2% six months ago; currently 6.2pp above the 2% target.

Policy Outlook: Inflation remains meaningfully above target. The Federal Reserve is likely to maintain a restrictive stance, keeping rates elevated until sustained disinflation is evident across multiple core gauges.

Core PCE (Fed-preferred), PPI Final Demand & 5-Year Breakeven — pipeline pressures and market inflation expectations, 10-year history. Dashed amber = 2% target

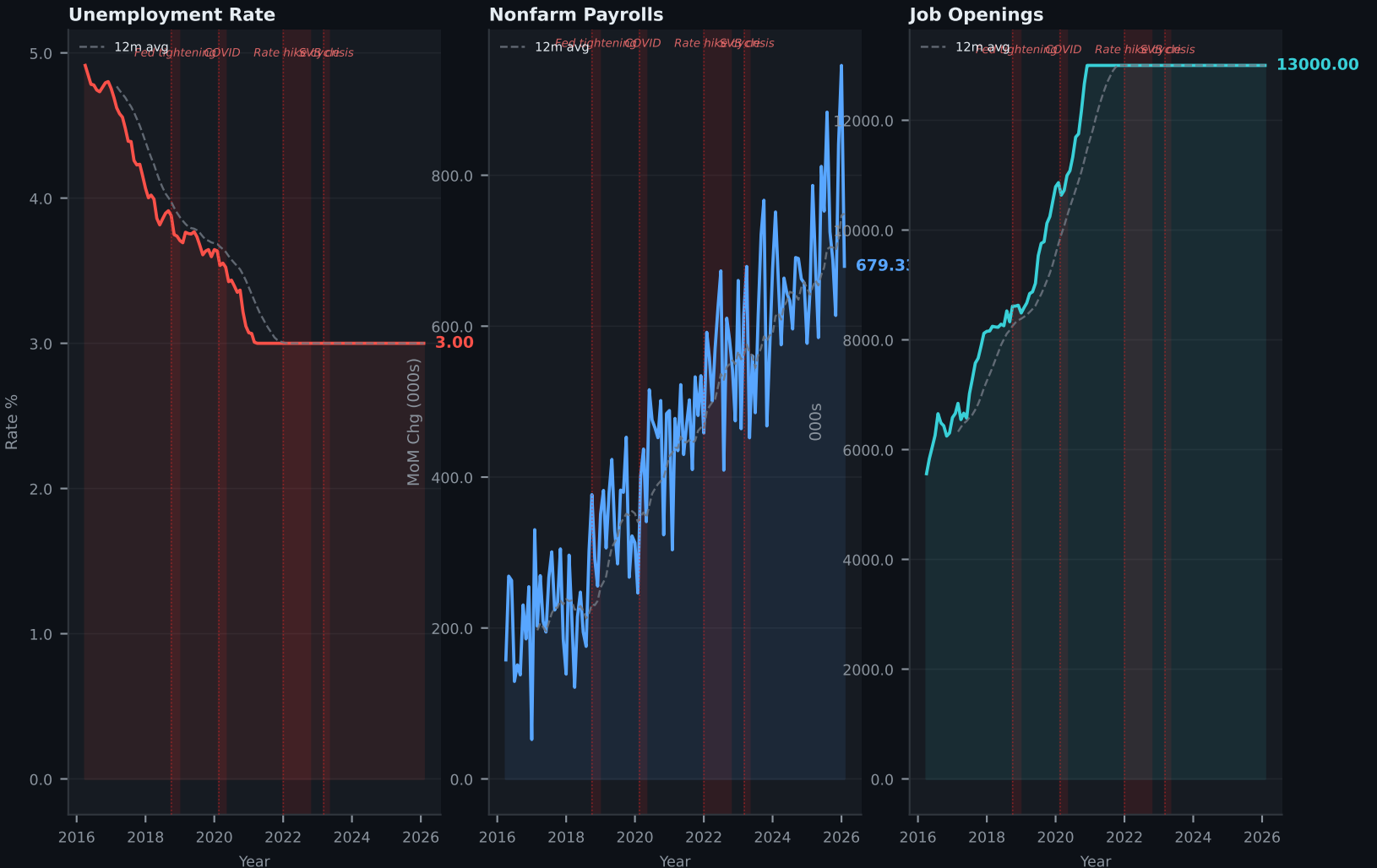


MACRO ANALYSIS — INFLATION

- Core PCE: 7.4% YoY — Stable from 7.5% six months ago; currently 5.4pp above the 2% target.
- PPI (Final Dem): 6.7% YoY — Falling from 7.3% six months ago; currently 4.7pp above the 2% target.
- 5Y Breakeven: 1.89% — Market-implied 5-year avg inflation; anchored near the 2% target. Long-run expectations remain well-anchored.

Policy Outlook: Inflation remains meaningfully above target. The Federal Reserve is likely to maintain a restrictive stance, keeping rates elevated until sustained disinflation is evident across multiple core gauges.

Unemployment Rate, Nonfarm Payrolls & JOLTS Job Openings — demand-side labor indicators, 10-year history. Shaded regions = key macro stress events.

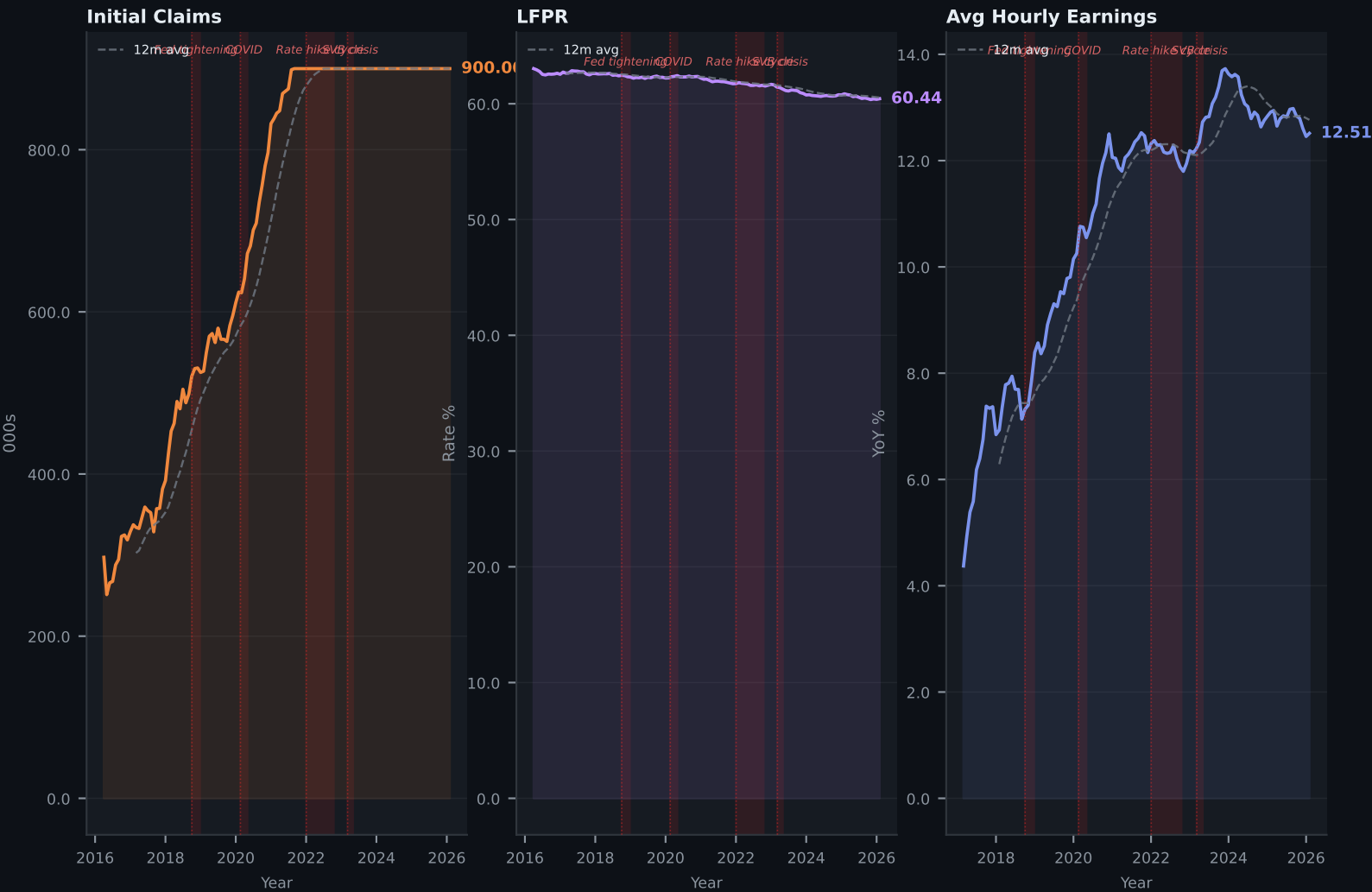


MACRO ANALYSIS — LABOR MARKET

- Unemployment Rate: 3.0% — Historically tight; near the Fed's estimated long-run rate of ~4.0%.
- Nonfarm Payrolls: +679K MoM — Latest monthly job creation; strong pace relative to the ~100-150K breakeven rate.
- Job Openings: 13.0M — JOLTS openings; robust labor demand (13.0M vs ~7M pre-pandemic).

Labor Market Outlook: At 3.0% unemployment the labor market remains historically tight. The Fed sees limited need for emergency stimulus; robust wage growth continues to underpin consumer spending and support GDP resilience.

Initial Jobless Claims, Labor Force Participation & Avg Hourly Earnings — supply-side and wage indicators, 10-year history. Shaded regions = key macro stress ev



MACRO ANALYSIS — LABOR MARKET

- Initial Claims: 900K wkly — Weekly UI filings; elevated — labor conditions softening.
- LFPR: 60.4% — Share of civilians in the labor force; 3.0pp below the pre-pandemic peak of ~63.4%.
- Avg Hourly Earnings: 12.5% YoY — Wage growth elevated, sustaining consumer spending; still contributing to sticky services inflation.

Labor Market Outlook: Unemployment at 4.1% signals a healthy but moderating labor market. Payroll growth has cooled from post-pandemic peaks, gradually easing wage pressures. The FOMC is watching for further softening that might justify accelerating the pace of rate cuts.